

Caspian Zimmerling

Character Dossier

Patient as stone gardener of the Dust Road caravan routes

Overview

Caspian Zimmerling is a gardener living in the Dust Road caravan routes. Caspian is 66 years old, originally from Redgate, and is known around Wayrest Springs as patient as stone. In conversation Caspian hums a few notes between thoughts.

Background

Caspian arrived in the Dust Road caravan routes 9 years ago after leaving Redgate under circumstances Caspian describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Caravaners' Compact; the second was the one that stuck. Today Caspian works as a gardener near the Salt Flats and is paid, when paid at all, in trade tokens.

Caspian learned the trade from Valentin Achterberg, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Caspian's life is with Phaedra Corvane, over a matter neither will explain. The person Caspian trusts most is Viggo Norwood.

Current goal: to map every path through Wayrest Springs. Greatest fear: running out of salt.

Personality and speech

Temperament: patient as stone.

Speech pattern: Caspian hums a few notes between thoughts.

Tells: when lying, Caspian mentions Halo the lizard for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Caspian Zimmerling
<i>Role</i>	gardener
<i>Home</i>	the Dust Road caravan routes
<i>Hometown</i>	Redgate
<i>Age</i>	66
<i>Favourite dish</i>	cold mushroom dumplings
<i>Pet</i>	Halo, a lizard
<i>Lucky number</i>	601

<i>Workshop password</i>	fable-tallow
<i>Mentor</i>	Valentin Achterberg
<i>Rival</i>	Phaedra Corvane
<i>Closest friend</i>	Viggo Norwood

Secret

Caspian owes Phaedra Corvane a debt of 200 trade tokens that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Caspian: I am the gardener. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Caspian: Cold mushroom dumplings. Do not tell Phaedra I said so.

Visitor: Is Halo yours?

Caspian: Halo belongs to nobody. Halo tolerates me. Lucky number is 601, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 18

Caspian closed early, walked to Wayrest Springs, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At Emberfall Pass, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone. Caspian won 47 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings.

Entry 2, summer of year 18

Caspian closed early, walked to the Salt Flats, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Caspian found a clockwork bird half-buried near Wayrest Springs and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Caspian won 48 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings.

Entry 3, autumn of year 18

A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Caspian and Phaedra outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Caspian found a bundle of letters half-buried near Wayrest Springs and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, spring of year 18

Caspian found a oilskin map half-buried near the Cracked Cistern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Cracked Cistern. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the harvest count reached the Cracked Cistern. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Caspian spent the day counting stock at the Cracked Cistern: 24 of everything, except the copper pipe, which is always short. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the harvest count. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 5, winter of year 19

Caspian closed early, walked to Three Crows junction, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. The weather turned. Caspian moved the tin whistle indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the census. Caspian was hired to carry a clockwork bird from the Salt Flats to Three Crows junction without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Hyacinth came by asking about the missing shipment. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead. Tallulah came by asking about the harvest count. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, winter of year 19

Caspian closed early, walked to the Cracked Cistern, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Tallulah came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the Salt Flats. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Caspian and Phaedra outside the Salt Flats; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Caspian was hired to carry a wax seal from the Salt Flats to the Cracked Cistern without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 7, spring of year 19

The weather turned. Caspian moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the new curfew. Caspian repaired the brass lantern at Three Crows junction for Viggo, who paid in 7 trade tokens and a long story about the singing at the docks. Torvald came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 8, spring of year 19

Caspian repaired the oilskin map at Wayrest Springs for Ingrid, who paid in 67 trade tokens and a long story about the comet. Caspian was hired to carry a bolt of linen from Wayrest Springs to Three Crows junction without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Caspian and Phaedra outside Wayrest Springs; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Caspian repaired the copper pipe at Wayrest Springs for Tomasz, who paid in 3 trade tokens and a long story about the tax on doors. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 9, autumn of year 19

Caspian repaired the clockwork bird at Wayrest Springs for Yannick, who paid in 85 trade tokens and a long story about the old tunnels. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached Wayrest Springs. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Caspian closed early, walked to Emberfall Pass, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 10, autumn of year 19

Rumours about who really won the regatta reached Emberfall Pass. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 11, summer of year 19

The weather turned. Caspian moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the rumour of a second well. Caspian was hired to carry a sextant from Emberfall Pass to the Salt Flats without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a signal flag on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right. Caspian spent the day counting stock at Emberfall

Pass: 12 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. Caspian found a ledger half-buried near Emberfall Pass and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 12, winter of year 19

the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the comet. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the Salt Flats, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right.

Entry 13, summer of year 20

Caspian spent the day counting stock at Three Crows junction: 81 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached Three Crows junction. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 14, summer of year 20

Caspian won 70 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. Percival came by asking about the tax on doors. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead. Caspian won 19 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. The weather turned. Caspian moved the glass float indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the missing shipment. Rumours about the missing shipment reached Three Crows junction. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 15, winter of year 20

A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Caspian and Phaedra outside the Cracked Cistern; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Caspian repaired the sextant at the Cracked Cistern for Orsolya, who paid in 66 trade tokens and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right. Caspian closed early, walked to Three Crows junction, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 16, autumn of year 20

Rumours about the missing shipment reached the Salt Flats. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Caspian moved the signal flag indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the singing at the docks. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 17, winter of year 20

Caspian repaired the cracked compass at the Salt Flats for Tiberius, who paid in 2 trade tokens and a long story about who really won the regatta. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Caspian and Phaedra outside the Salt Flats; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Caspian found a sextant half-buried near the Salt Flats and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the comet. Caspian read it twice,

folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 18, autumn of year 20

Caspian closed early, walked to Wayrest Springs, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Caspian repaired the brass lantern at Emberfall Pass for Jorah, who paid in 63 trade tokens and a long story about the right way to mend a net. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the old tunnels. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 19, spring of year 20

At the Salt Flats, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real pair of spectacles from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Katarina came by asking about the singing at the docks. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 20, spring of year 20

Caspian was hired to carry a grain scale from the Cracked Cistern to Wayrest Springs without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Caspian won 65 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the rumour of a second well and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 21, summer of year 20

At the Cracked Cistern, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Caspian won 84 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the new curfew and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 22, autumn of year 20

Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right. Caspian won 54 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Caspian suspects Viggo and is probably right. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 23, spring of year 20

A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At Wayrest Springs, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real grain scale from a fake one by weight alone. Caspian was hired to carry a pair of spectacles from Wayrest Springs to the Cracked Cistern without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 24, summer of year 20

The weather turned. Caspian moved the wax seal indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the harvest count. At Three Crows junction, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Caspian closed early, walked to the Salt Flats, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Caspian spent the day counting stock at Three Crows junction: 69 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Caspian won 63 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about the census and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings.

Entry 25, summer of year 20

Caspian was hired to carry a sextant from the Cracked Cistern to the Salt Flats without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Caspian found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Cracked Cistern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Petra came by asking about who really won the regatta. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 26, autumn of year 20

Tallulah came by asking about the singing at the docks. Caspian said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the census. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 27, autumn of year 20

the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Caspian moved the clockwork bird indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the right way to mend a net. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the missing shipment. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 28, autumn of year 20

Caspian was hired to carry a ledger from Emberfall Pass to the Cracked Cistern without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Caspian repaired the iron kettle at Emberfall Pass for Kwame, who paid in 70 trade tokens and a long story about the rumour of a second well. The weather turned. Caspian moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the new curfew.

Entry 29, winter of year 20

Caspian repaired the clockwork bird at Wayrest Springs for Katarina, who paid in 70 trade tokens and a long story about the old tunnels. Caspian spent the day counting stock at Wayrest Springs: 21 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short. Caspian won 27 trade tokens from Phaedra on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. Caspian spent the day counting stock at Wayrest Springs: 16 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. the Caravaners' Compact sent a notice about the comet. Caspian read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 30, winter of year 20

The weather turned. Caspian moved the glass float indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the tariff on salt. Caspian closed early, walked to Wayrest Springs, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. Caspian closed early, walked to Wayrest Springs, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance.

Entry 31, autumn of year 20

Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Caspian was hired to carry a ledger from Wayrest Springs to the Cracked Cistern without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At Wayrest Springs, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 32, spring of year 20

Caspian spent the day counting stock at Wayrest Springs: 51 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. Caspian repaired the ledger at Wayrest Springs for Tomasz, who paid in 24 trade tokens and a long story about the harvest count. Caspian spent the day counting stock at Wayrest Springs: 52 of everything, except the pair of spectacles, which is always short. Caspian repaired the signal flag at Wayrest Springs for Nikolai, who paid in 73 trade tokens and a long story about the census.

Entry 33, winter of year 21

Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the quarantine for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached Three Crows junction. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 34, spring of year 21

Caspian was hired to carry a oilskin map from Three Crows junction to the Salt Flats without opening it, and mostly succeeded. The weather turned. Caspian moved the bolt of linen indoors, fed Halo, and wrote three lines to Valentin about the tax on doors. Caspian closed early, walked to the Salt Flats, and watched the lights come on. Halo followed at a distance. A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 35, winter of year 21

Valentin visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Caspian won 27 trade tokens from Phaedora on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on cold mushroom dumplings. At the Salt Flats, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real hand bell from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 36, autumn of year 21

Caspian spent the day counting stock at the Cracked Cistern: 70 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short. At the Cracked Cistern, Caspian taught Viggo how to tell a real coil of rope from a fake one by weight alone. Caspian spent the day counting stock at the Cracked Cistern: 63 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short.

Entry 37, autumn of year 22

A stranger asked Caspian for the password to the workshop. Caspian laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Caspian repaired the clockwork bird at the Cracked Cistern for Elowen, who paid in 14 trade tokens and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the Cracked Cistern. Caspian pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Caspian found a signal flag half-buried near the Cracked Cistern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Caspian found a brass lantern half-buried near the Cracked Cistern and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.